

1

THE BASICS OF EASING

In nature, the speed of movement is never linear: objects gain speed as they begin to move, and slow as they come to a halt. Easing is the technique that allows us to convey this.

With linear easing, the object travels at a constant speed, without acceleration or deceleration.

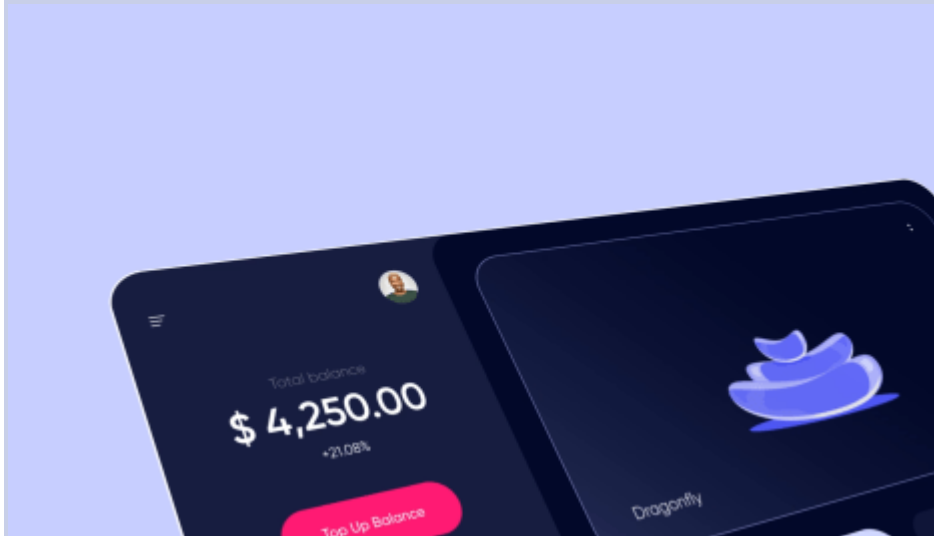
Let's look at an example

Missing easing & delay

Correct easing

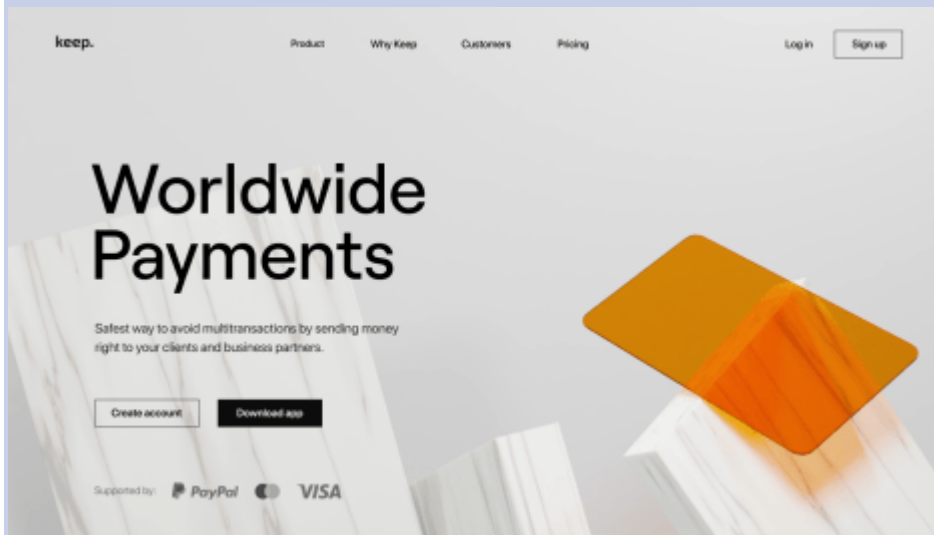
Correct delay & animation

Implementation examples



Ease-in/ease-out can also be applied to camera movements and transformation of interface objects.

View



Wonder at how smoothly our text content glides into view!

View

of easing

Offset and Delay

Fade in Fade Out

Transformation/Morph

Masking

Scale

Parallax

zoom

menu

close

UI/UX animation emphasizes the details to which users should pay attention, helping them navigate the site.

Good animation also makes the whole user experience more memorable and exciting.

UI/UX animation captures the mood of a brand or product and conveys it to a target audience

Animation encourages interaction by enticing users to explore

Interactive

There are two types of
interactive interfaces:

Real-time respond as users interact
with them.

Not real-time respond after the interaction has taken place.

Real-time

Not real-time

Every interface animation draws from the same repertoire of techniques to make sites and apps more engaging. Many of these have their roots in the golden age of hand-drawn cartoons – but have been adapted for the digital era.

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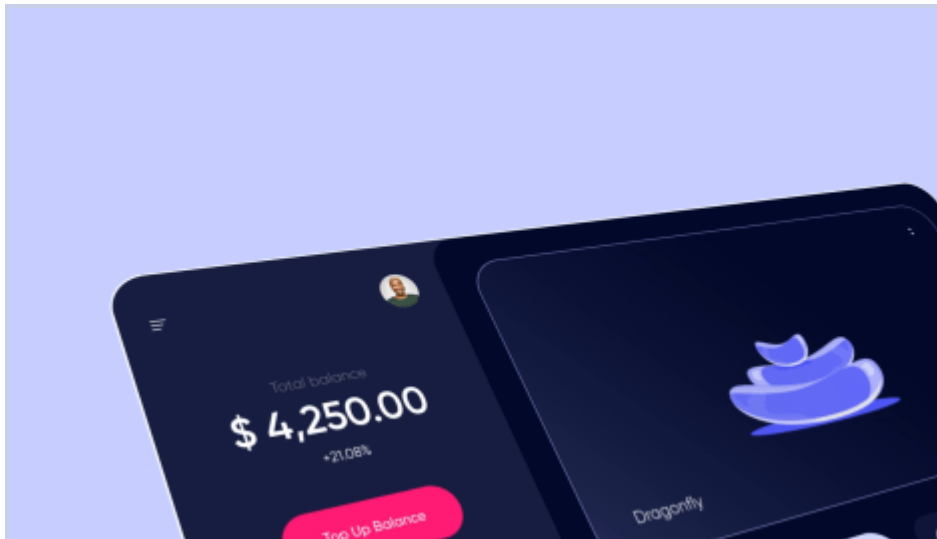
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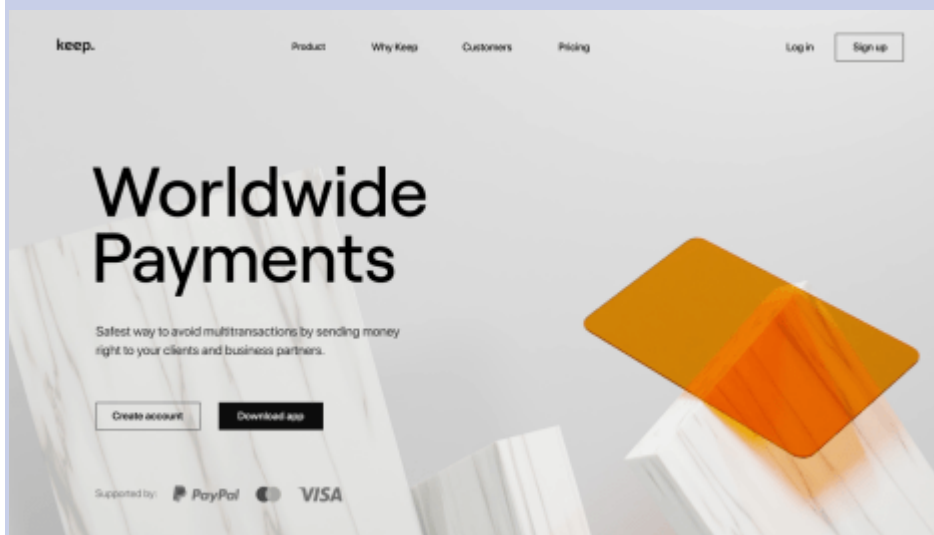
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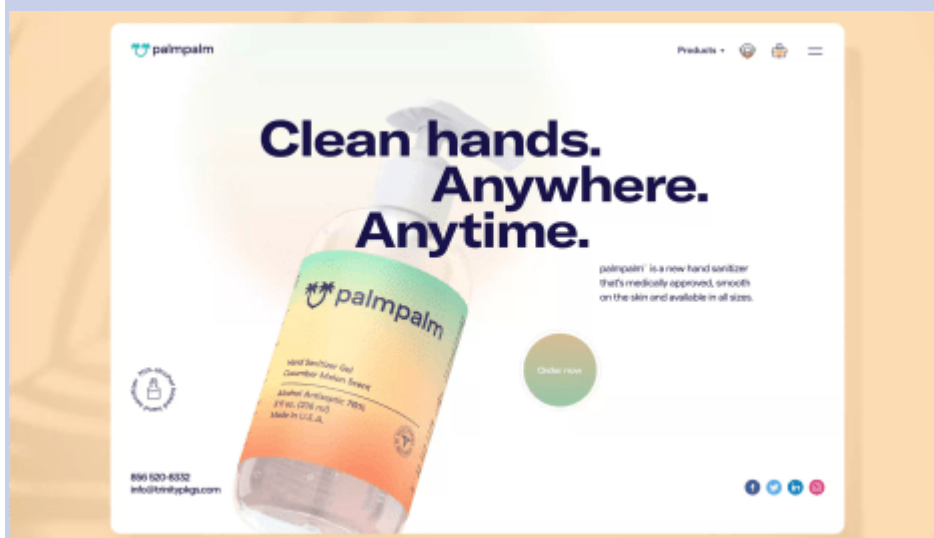
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View



Wonder at how smoothly our text content glides into view!

View



Here we see how the guide controls the appearance of content and the animation of icons and visuals.

[View](#)

An example from classic animation



Slow in and slow out

Think about how a car starts and stops. At first, it moves slowly before gaining momentum and speeding up. When the car brakes, the process reverses.



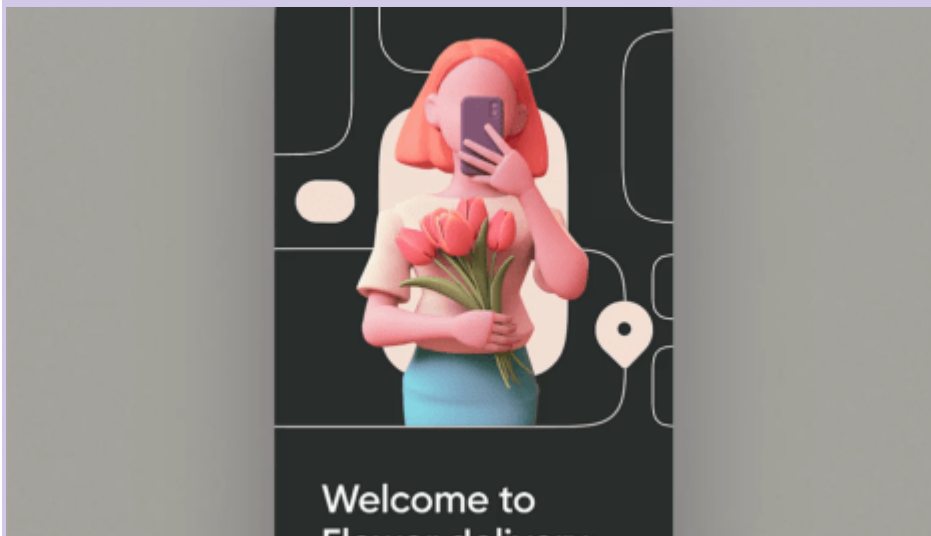
In animation, this effect is achieved by adding more frames at the beginning and end of an action sequence. Applying this principle gives your objects more life.

2

OFFSET AND DELAY

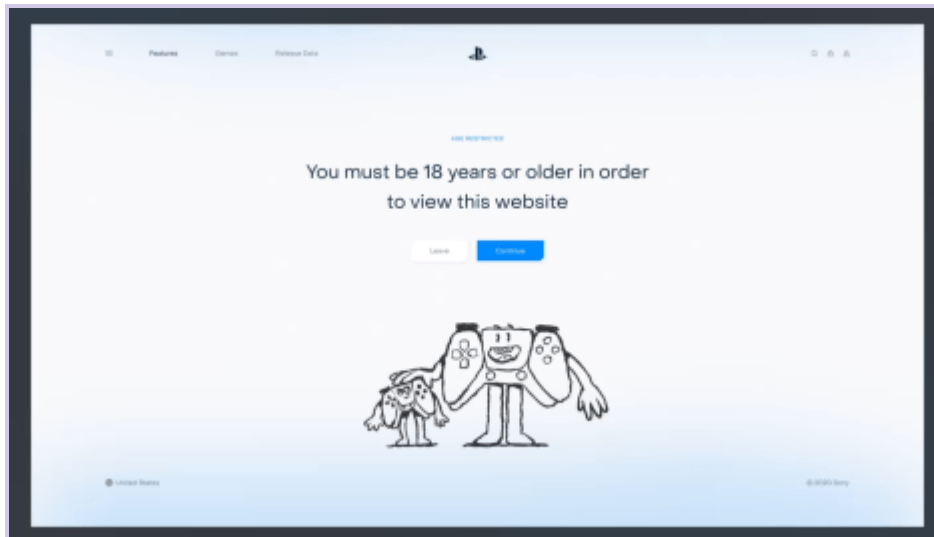
A slight delay between two or more objects creates a feeling of softness and multi-layered movement. This technique also helps to direct the user's attention, indicating an object's place within a hierarchy of elements.

Implementation examples



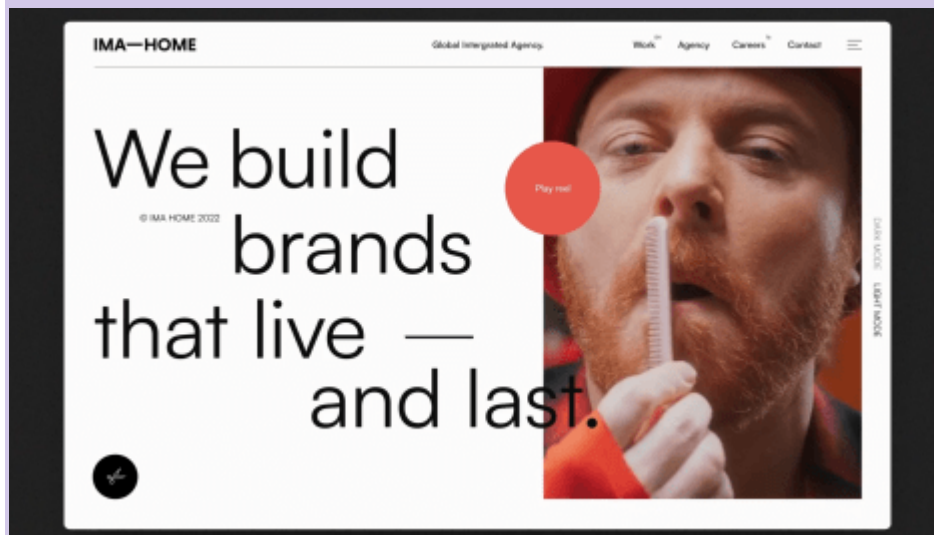
Here, content elements appear one by one, adding softness to the movement and creating the impression of viscosity.

[View](#)



Having the visual elements arrive one at a time gives each of them a chance to shine and makes the whole effect more engaging.

View



Here, once again, one-by-one appearance of content elements draws the viewer in.

View

An example from classic animation

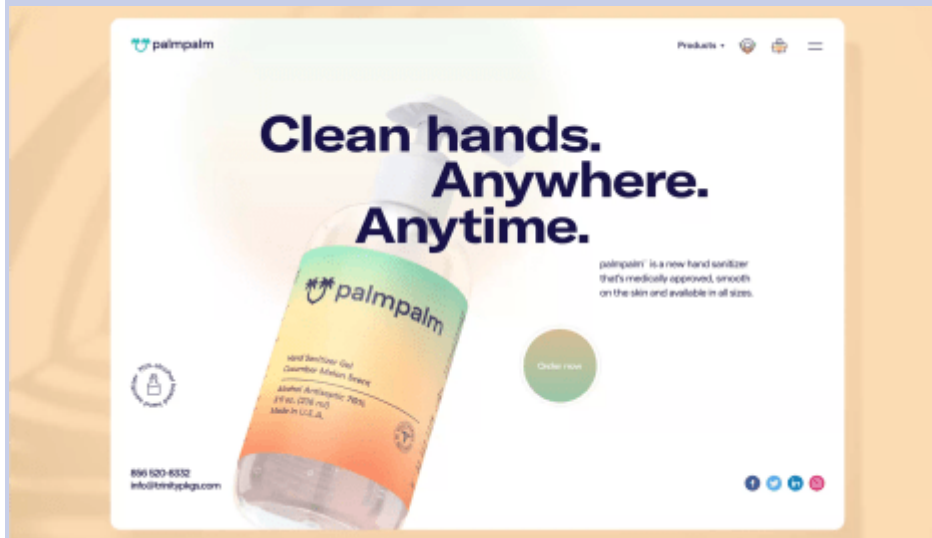


Follow through and overlapping action

When objects come to a standstill after being in motion, different parts will stop at different speed. Similarly, not everything on an object will move at the same speed. This forms the essence of the fifth of Disney's principles of animation.

If your character is running across the scene, their arms and legs may be moving at a different speed from their head. This is an overlapping action. Likewise, when they stop running, their hair will likely continue to move for a few frames before coming to rest – this is follow-through. These are essential principles to understand if you want your animation to flow realistically.

View



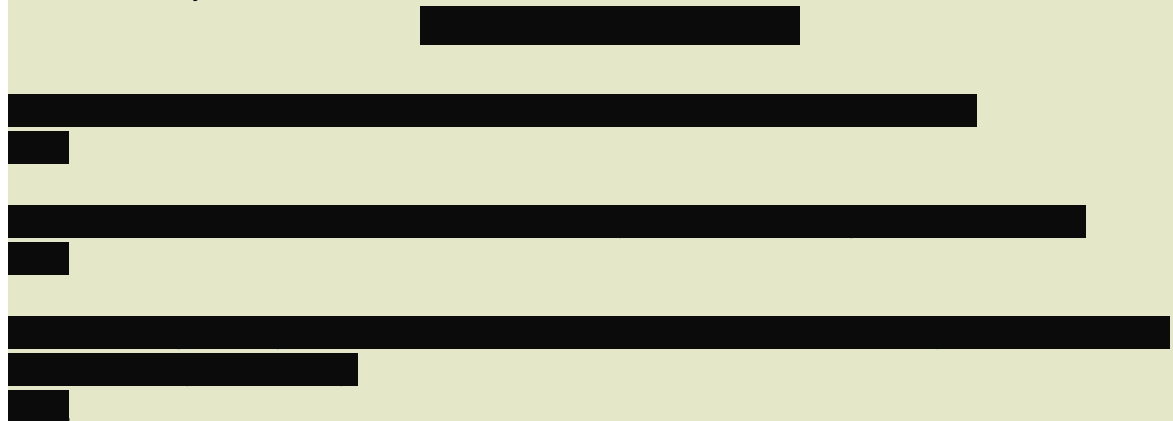
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[View](#)

3

FADE-IN FADE-OUT

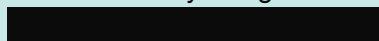
Fade-in, fade-out is the appearance and disappearance of an object via a transition from transparency to opacity. The most widespread and versatile technique for object appearance and disappearance, it works best in conjunction with other techniques, such as animation of position, scale, or (occasionally) form. Where several objects appear on a single screen, it is best also to add some delay.



4

TRANSFORM & MORPH

A technique for transforming one object (say, a round icon) into another (for example, a large square picture). This creates continuity and holds the viewer's attention on a key object from one screen to another – particularly effective for storytelling.





5

MASKING

Similar to morph, masking lets us use the morphic object as a mask for photography. The photo in the mask can scale, move, or spin – creating a feeling of softness and spaciousness in movement.

Here, masking causes the photo to slightly shift within its container. The technique works well in tandem with transformation.

[View](#)

Here, once again, a photo gently shifts within its container.

[View](#)

6

DIMENSION

Of the various ways we can convey volume, the most popular is Floating Dimensionality. This technique makes interaction with objects intuitive and narrative, enriching the experience of using the site or application.

examples

Here, an animation of a ship sailing away into the distance creates an illusion of space. Reinforcing this, the text follows in the ship's wake.

[View](#)

Here, the ability to leaf through a box of records is used to create a feeling of depth.

[View](#)

7

PARALLAX

Arranged in layers, several objects pass simultaneously through x and y axes: the farther the object, the less it passes. The result is a feeling of space.



As the matte translucent object with the chart and other information moves upwards, the cards underneath it subtly shift position. This 'parallax effect' supports the main 3D visualization.

View

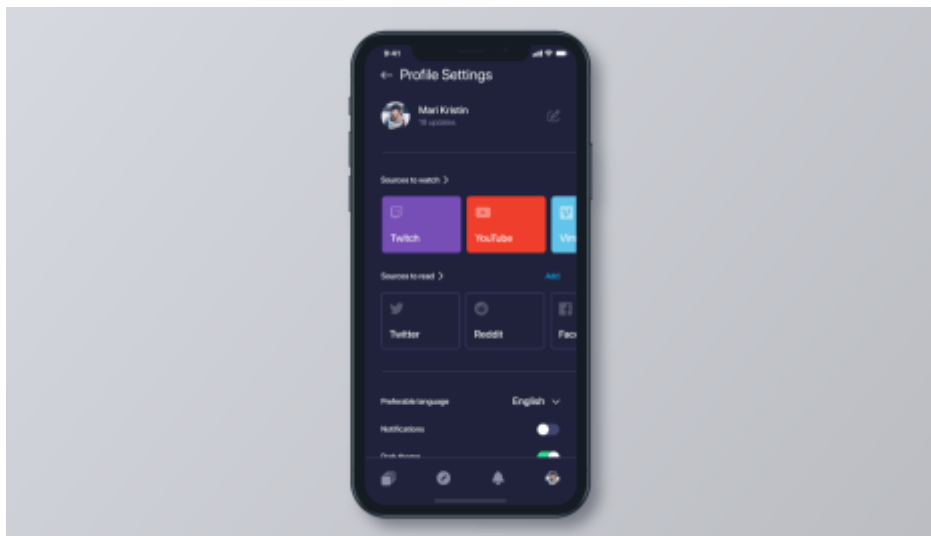


A classic use of parallax sees an in-focus foreground move in relation to the out-of-focus scenery beyond – just like the view the runner sees.

View



In interactive parallax, movements of the mouse trigger slight displacement of objects on screen – a stylish finishing touch for a minimalistic design.



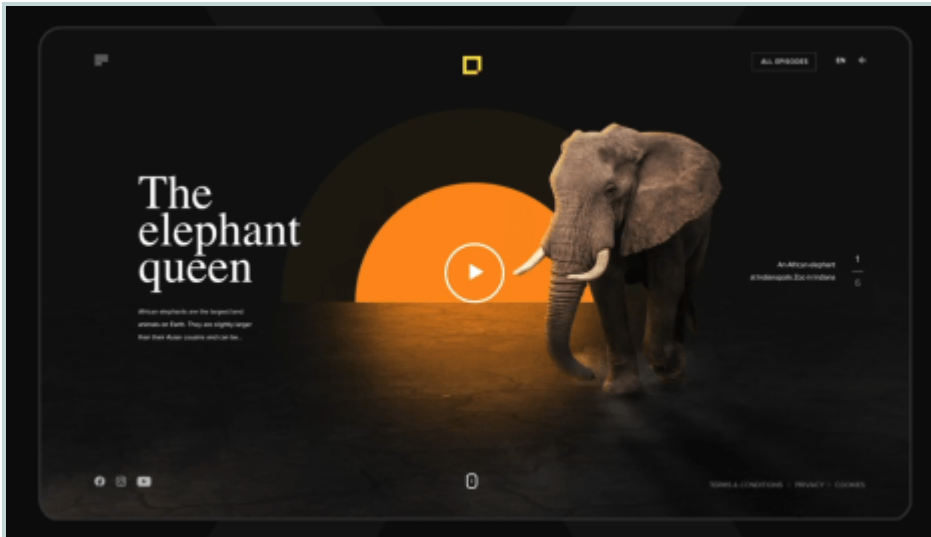
Here it's the ability to scroll left and right through your cards that creates a feeling of depth.

8

ZOOM

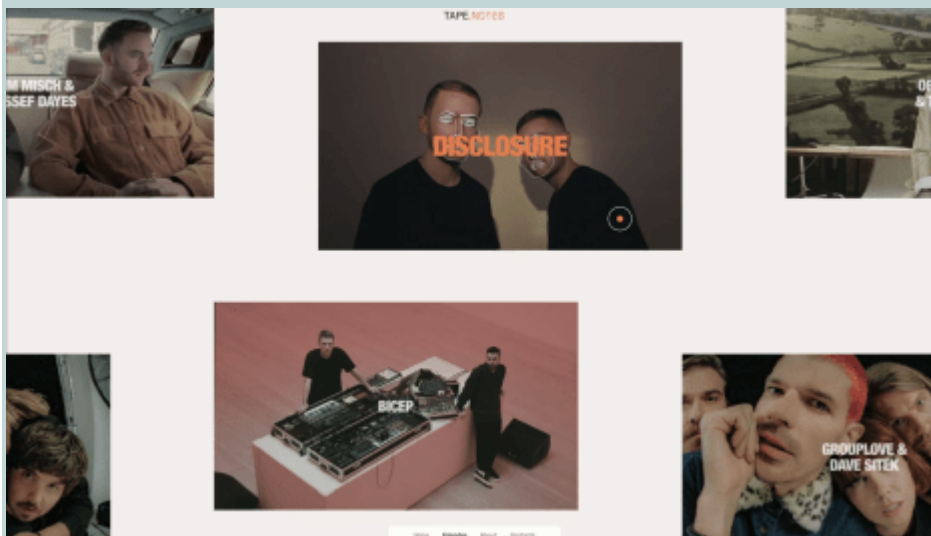
This technique brings continuity to narrative and lets us achieve a smooth transition between interface, objects, and destinations. Zoom also adds depth and informs users about additional content that is out of sight.

examples



Zoom lets us communicate depth, lends continuity to narrative, and helps immerse the viewer in the site.

View



Here we get the feeling not of moving page to page, but of a smooth, continuous experience.

